

Name: _____ Date: _____ Score: _____ / 30

Reading Comprehension Test

All Creatures Great and Small - Chapters 1-30

by James Herriot

Directions: Circle the letter of the best answer for each question.

Section 1: Easy

1. What difficult animal problem does Herriot face in the opening chapter?

- A. A cow has trouble delivering her calf in bitter winter weather.
- B. A pampered dog refuses to eat at a wealthy house after a long afternoon of visitors.
- C. A horse bolts through the village market.
- D. A pig escapes from Skeldale House during breakfast.

2. What does the young James Herriot hope to get from Siegfried Farnon?

- A. Permission to open a rival clinic nearby
- B. A place at veterinary school in Edinburgh
- C. A letter introducing him to Tricki Woo's owner
- D. A paid position in a veterinary practice

3. Where does Herriot come to live and work after Siegfried hires him?

- A. Cranford Farm
- B. The Drovers Arms
- C. Skeldale House
- D. Mrs. Pumphrey's estate

4. Who is Tristan Farnon?

- A. The bookkeeper who reorganizes the practice accounts after finding the records in a mess
- B. The farmer who questions Herriot's treatment of a horse
- C. The owner of Tricki Woo and several spoiled animals
- D. Siegfried's younger brother, who is less disciplined than Siegfried

5. What does Siegfried do after Soames complains about Herriot's decision with the horse?

- A. He supports Herriot after confirming the diagnosis was right.
- B. He sends Herriot back to school immediately.
- C. He asks Tristan to handle all horse cases from then on, even though Tristan is still unreliable.
- D. He refuses to speak to Soames again.

6. Who is Tricki Woo?

- A. A farm horse that teaches Herriot a painful lesson
- B. A spoiled little dog owned by Mrs. Pumphrey
- C. A piglet Tristan is supposed to feed
- D. A cow whose death leads to an insurance dispute

7. What mistake does Tristan make while collecting money for the practice?

- A. He sends every client to the wrong farm.
- B. He pays the farmers instead of billing them and then tries to cover the mistake with jokes.
- C. He loses or mismanages the payment book, causing confusion over who paid.
- D. He hides the money in the petty cash box without telling Siegfried.

8. Why does Siegfried hire a bookkeeper?

- A. To train Tristan to pass his veterinary exams by forcing him to copy receipts every evening
- B. To help Herriot diagnose horses more quickly
- C. To make the practice records and payments more orderly
- D. To manage Mrs. Pumphrey's gifts to Skeldale House

9. What happens when Siegfried tries keeping hens and pigs at Skeldale House?

- A. The animals make the practice look elegant and professional.
- B. The hens and pigs bring order to the household and make Skeldale House seem more professional.
- C. Tristan sells them secretly to pay the practice bills.
- D. The plan creates comic trouble, especially under Tristan's care.

10. Why does Herriot take Tricki Woo away from Mrs. Pumphrey near the end of chapter 30?

- A. Tricki Woo has been stolen by another farmer.
- B. Tricki Woo needs rest, exercise, and a simpler diet.
- C. Siegfried wants Tricki Woo to guard Skeldale House while the vets are away on farm calls.
- D. Mrs. Pumphrey asks Herriot to train him for a dog show.

Section 2: Medium**11. Why is the pub scene important for Herriot's new life in Darrowby?**

- A. Knowing the farmers personally helps him earn their trust.
- B. It proves that Herriot can avoid farm calls if he is friendly enough and learns everyone's favorite stories.
- C. It gives Herriot a chance to sell veterinary textbooks to local people.
- D. It makes Siegfried decide to leave the practice.

12. What does Herriot learn from his first day of farm calls with Siegfried?

- A. Rural veterinary work is mostly paperwork and polite conversation with clean instruments nearby.
- B. Most farmers prefer young vets to experienced ones.
- C. Real practice is physically demanding and unpredictable.
- D. Siegfried expects Tristan to do the hardest jobs.

13. Why does Herriot refuse payment from the elderly man whose dog must be put down?

- A. He knows the man wants to buy another expensive dog that day and would rather spend his money there.
- B. He forgot to bring the practice receipt book.
- C. Siegfried has ordered him never to charge poor clients.
- D. Compassion matters more than the fee.

14. How does the bookkeeper's arrival expose a weakness in Siegfried's practice?

- A. The medical work is careless and usually wrong because the vets spend too much time joking together.
- B. The practice depends on charm more than organized records.
- C. The farmers have stopped trusting Herriot completely.
- D. Tristan has secretly kept perfect accounts for years.

15. Why is Herriot humbled by the old horse and the experienced farmer?

- A. He learns that farmers know nothing useful about animals despite living beside them every day.
- B. He realizes textbook knowledge does not replace practical experience.
- C. He decides horses are easier to treat than small dogs.
- D. He discovers Siegfried gave him the wrong medicine on purpose.

16. What is the real source of many of Tricki Woo's health problems?

- A. He has too little attention from Mrs. Pumphrey.

- B. He is secretly being fed by Tristan at Skeldale House whenever Siegfried leaves the room.
- C. He is overfed and gets too little exercise.
- D. He catches the same illness as the farm pigs.

17. Why is the farmer disappointed when Herriot recommends Epsom salts for sick livestock?

- A. The farmer has already used Epsom salts and knows they cannot work on any serious livestock problem.
- B. The treatment is so expensive that it will ruin the farm.
- C. Siegfried has forbidden Herriot to use old remedies.
- D. The farmer had hoped for an impressive modern treatment.

18. What does Herriot's simple treatment for the overheated bull show?

- A. Dramatic-looking medicine is always better than ordinary common sense.
- B. A correct diagnosis can make a very simple remedy effective.
- C. Farmers never understand animal illness without a laboratory test.
- D. Herriot guesses randomly and gets lucky.

19. Why does the insurance claim for the dead cow fail?

- A. Herriot and the knacker both find a natural cause of death.
- B. Siegfried refuses to examine any dead animals because he thinks insurance work is beneath him.
- C. The farmer forgets which cow was insured.
- D. Tristan accidentally mails the insurance papers to the laboratory.

20. What makes Tristan's ointment mistake with Mr. Cranford especially funny and embarrassing?

- A. He gives Cranford an expensive horse medicine instead of a cheap cow medicine.
- B. He delivers the practice's petty cash instead of the medicine.
- C. He sends Siegfried's personal letter to the wrong client.
- D. He mixes up a treatment package with a sample meant for the laboratory.

Section 3: Hard

21. Which theme is best shown by Herriot's early struggles in chapters 1-5?

- A. Competence grows through uncomfortable real-world tests.
- B. Success comes mainly from avoiding criticism and never admitting uncertainty in front of farmers.
- C. Formal education makes experience unnecessary.
- D. Animals are easier to understand than people.

22. What does Siegfried's reaction to Soames reveal about him at his best?

- A. He cares more about winning arguments than about animal care or helping a young assistant learn.
- B. He protects a younger colleague when the facts support him.
- C. He wants Tristan to become the main veterinarian.
- D. He believes farmers should never question a vet.

23. How do Siegfried's contradictions shape the humor of the early chapters?

- A. They make the animal cases less serious than they really are by turning every diagnosis into a joke.
- B. They prove Siegfried is dishonest in every part of his work.
- C. They turn ordinary problems into comic confusion.
- D. They remove the need for Herriot to make his own judgments.

24. Which comparison best explains the difference between Siegfried and Tristan?

- A. Siegfried is careful with money, while Tristan is obsessed with bookkeeping and household discipline.
- B. Siegfried is forceful but inconsistent; Tristan is charming and careless.
- C. Siegfried dislikes animals, while Tristan understands them perfectly.

D. Siegfried avoids jokes, while Tristan never plays any.

25. Why does the story of the elderly man and his dog deepen the book beyond comedy?

- A. It proves Herriot should stop treating farm animals.
- B. It shows that all animal owners are foolish about their pets and should trust vets without asking questions.
- C. It turns Siegfried into the main character for the rest of the book.
- D. Veterinary work includes grief, mercy, and human loneliness.

26. What is ironic about Mrs. Pumphrey's love for Tricki Woo?

- A. Her generosity makes Tricki Woo dislike Herriot and refuse every treatment Herriot recommends.
- B. Her affection is sincere, but it harms the dog.
- C. She cares more about farm animals than her own pet.
- D. She pays too little attention to the dog to notice he is sick.

27. How do the Epsom salts and cold-water bull cases work together?

- A. They show that Herriot is afraid to use any treatment from veterinary school.
- B. They show that farmers always prefer simple remedies.
- C. They suggest that wisdom often looks unimpressive when it is exactly right.
- D. They prove that Siegfried's practice never uses modern knowledge.

28. What does Herriot gradually learn about the Dales farmers?

- A. They are impossible to please and have no real knowledge beyond repeating village gossip about animals.
- B. They are all dishonest whenever money is involved.
- C. They care only about tradition and refuse every new method.
- D. They are blunt but often have hard-earned practical wisdom.

29. What is the best interpretation of the practice's financial disorder?

- A. It shows the practice is informal and personality-driven.
- B. It proves the vets do not care about their animal patients because they care only about collecting fees.
- C. It exists only because farmers never pay any bills.
- D. It is solved completely as soon as Tristan returns.

30. Why is chapters 1-30 a fitting introduction to Herriot's world?

- A. They focus mostly on famous people and city medicine.
- B. They show only the tragic side of veterinary practice and avoid the comic parts of rural life.
- C. They blend hard work, humility, humor, compassion, and affection for rural life.
- D. They avoid character development so the animal cases can stand alone.